



MODULE 06 · PROCESS

Trader Routine

Good trading is boring on purpose. A repeatable routine — prepare, wait, execute, review — quietly removes the two costliest habits a beginner has: improvising, and overtrading.

BEGINNER

15 MIN READ

“Discipline before conviction.”

BY THE END, YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

01

Build a **premarket checklist** you run every day

02

Know **when to stand aside** — not trading is a position

03

Review trades on facts, without emotional storytelling

01 THE PROCESS IS THE EDGE

Repeatable beats brilliant

You can't control the market, the news, or any single outcome. You *can* control the steps you run before, during, and after every trade — and that is where consistency actually comes from.

Most beginner losses don't come from bad analysis. They come from **improvising** — entering on a whim, sizing by feel, holding on hope — and from **overtrading**, taking marginal setups out of boredom or the urge to “do something.”

A routine fixes both. It decides, in advance and while you're calm, what a real opportunity looks like and what you'll do when one appears — so the heat of the moment has far less room to hurt you. The same routine, every single day, is the entire point.

▲ IMPROVISING

Different process every day — entries, size, and exits decided live, on emotion. Unrepeatable, so un-improvable.

▲ OVERTRADING

Taking trades to feel busy, not because the plan called for them. Each marginal trade leaks fees, focus, and capital.

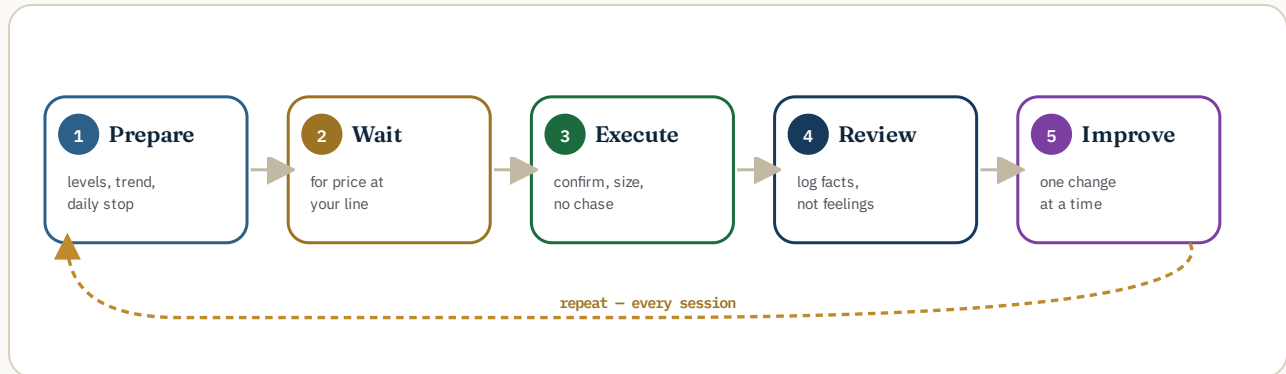
◆ KEY IDEA

A routine converts trading from a series of impulsive decisions into one repeated checklist. Repeatable actions produce reviewable results — and only reviewable results can be **improved**.

02 FIVE STEPS, EVERY DAY

The trader's loop

The whole routine is a cycle of five steps. Four of them happen away from the click — which tells you where the real work lives.



- ◆ **Prepare** — before the open, map the levels and trend context and set your daily stop while calm.
- ◆ **Wait** — the hardest step. Do nothing until price actually reaches a level you planned for.
- ◆ **Execute** — only on confirmation; size to risk; never chase. (This is Modules 02–04 in action.)
- ◆ **Review** — after the close, record what happened in plain facts.
- ◆ **Improve** — change one small thing, then run the loop again tomorrow.

03 THE BRIEF, BEFORE THE BELL

Your premarket checklist

Ten quiet minutes before the open is worth an hour of reacting after it. Run the same short brief every day, in the same order.

- ☐ **Mark the key levels**
Prior day's high/low, overnight range, obvious round numbers — the lines price actually reacts to.
- ☐ **Read the trend context**
Which way is the higher-timeframe MA sloping? Up, down, or flat (stand-aside) — from Module 05.
- ☐ **Check the calendar**
Any scheduled news or economic releases that could whip price? Note the times; respect them.
- ☐ **Set the day's risk**
Your per-trade risk and your daily stop — decided now, in writing, before the bell.
- ☐ **Build a small watchlist**
Two or three names with a clear level nearby. Fewer screens, better decisions.
- ☐ **Write the 'if-then'**
"If price reaches X and confirms, I do Y." Pre-deciding removes improvisation later.

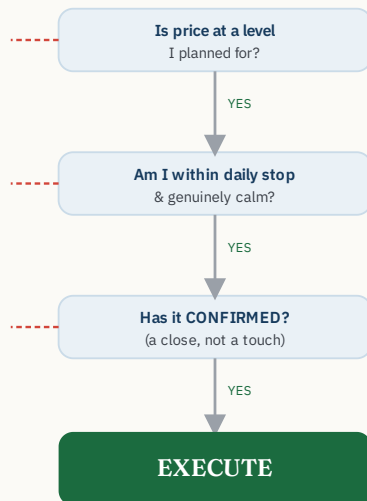
■ THE GOAL OF THE BRIEF

To walk into the session already knowing **where** you'd act, **what** would have to happen first, and **how much** you'd risk. Then your only live job is to wait and watch — not to invent a plan in real time.

04 NOT TRADING IS A POSITION

When to stand aside

The strongest discipline a trader builds is the willingness to do nothing. Most of the trading day is a “no” — and protecting that “no” protects the account.



Three gates stand between you and a trade. **Any** “no” sends you back to waiting — that’s not a missed trade, it’s a trade you correctly declined.

STAND ASIDE WHEN...

- ◆ price is nowhere near a level you mapped
- ◆ the market is choppy / the MA is flat
- ◆ you’ve hit your daily stop
- ◆ you’re tilted, tired, or bored
- ◆ you’d be chasing a move that already ran

◆ KEY IDEA

Cash is a position. A day with zero trades because nothing qualified is a **good day** — you protected capital and waited for the market to come to you.

05 THE MOMENT OF THE CLICK

Execute without improvising

When a setup finally arrives, the work is already done. Execution is just running the same short checklist — the discipline from Modules 02–04, fused into a few seconds.

- ☐ Price is at my planned level — I'm not chasing.
- ☐ It **confirmed** with a close, not just a wick touch.
- ☐ My **invalidation** level is set on structure.
- ☐ Size is calculated so the loss = my fixed risk.
- ☐ Reward is at least ~2R from here.
- ☐ I'm within my daily stop and calm. → **Click**.

After entry, the plan keeps running on its own: the **stop** defines your exit if wrong, the **target** if right. Your job shifts from deciding to **managing** — honour the levels you set, and resist the urge to move the stop further away or bail before the idea is actually proven or disproven.

■ LET IT WORK

Once placed, a good trade needs space and time. Babysitting every tick invites you to override your own plan.

▲ THE OVERRIDE URGE

Moving a stop, doubling down, or exiting early “just because” are all improvising in disguise. The plan was made when you were calmer — trust it.

06

FACTS, NOT FEELINGS

Review without the storytelling

A journal is where improvement actually happens — but only if it records *what occurred*, not the dramatic story you tell yourself about it afterward.

“The market was out to get me” teaches nothing. “I entered before the close and got faked out” teaches everything. Log the trade as a series of **checkable facts**, grade yourself on **process not outcome**, and extract exactly **one** lesson.

A SIMPLE TRADE-JOURNAL TEMPLATE		
Date / time	2026-05-22, 10:14	<i>plain fact</i>
Setup / level	pullback to rising MA at 580	<i>what you saw</i>
Entry / Stop / Target	580.00 / 577.50 / 585.00	<i>the numbers</i>
Planned R	2.0R	<i>decided before</i>
Result	+1.8R (target trim)	<i>what happened</i>
Followed the plan?	Yes	<i>the only grade that matters</i>
One lesson	exited a hair early on nerves	<i>one, specific, actionable</i>

◆

PROCESS OVER OUTCOME

A losing trade where you followed every rule is a **good** trade — the math just didn’t fall your way this time. A winning trade where you broke your rules is a **bad** one that got lucky. Grade the process, and the outcomes follow over time.

07 LOCK IT IN

What to carry forward

Six habits that turn scattered trades into a process you can actually get better at, week after week.

- 1 The **process is the edge** — repeatable beats brilliant.
- 2 Run the same **five-step loop** every day: prepare, wait, execute, review, improve.
- 3 A **premarket brief** pre-decides where, what, and how much.
- 4 **Standing aside** is a position; most of the day is a ‘no’.
- 5 **Execute** on confirmation, sized to risk, never chasing.
- 6 **Review on facts** and grade the process, not the outcome.

✓ START-HERE PATH COMPLETE

6 / 6 MODULES

You now have the vocabulary, the price-reading, the risk rules, and the routine. The rest is repetition.

THE SIX RULES THAT PROTECT THE PROCESS

- | | | |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------|
| I Trade structure, not stories. | II Hold a high bar. | III Wait for confirmation. |
| IV Do not chase. | V Honor invalidation. | VI Know when to stop. |

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